WHAT WAS THE FIRST PLASTIC?

The first plastic was Parkesine, invented in 1856 and named after its creator, Alexander Parkes. Now better known as celluloid, Parkesine was initially used to make billiard balls.

500 BILLION
THE **NUMBER OF PLASTIC BAGS** USED WORLDWIDE **EVERY YEAR**



COMMON TYPES OF PLASTIC	
Name	**Characteristics**
PET Polyethylene terephthalate	The most common type of plastic, PET comes in soft forms, used to make fibers for clothing, and harder forms used to make items such as beverage bottles.
PVC Polyvinyl chloride	Rigid and strong, PVC is used to make credit cards and in construction for pipes and door and window frames. In a softer form, it is a substitute for leather and rubber.
PP Polypropylene	Similar to PET but harder and more heat resistant, polypropylene is the second most widely used plastic, often used in packaging, including microwavable meal trays and bottle caps.
PC Polycarbonate	Polycarbonates are tough, and some grades are transparent. It is used for CDs and DVDs, sunglasses and safety goggles, and in construction for dome lights and flat or curved glazing.
PS Polystyrene	Polystyrene can be clear, hard, and brittle, often used for cases of small items. It can also be filled with tiny gas bubbles to make the light foam used for egg cartons and single-use cups.

